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Syntype: When more than one specimen cited by the author in the protologue without designating holotype.

Neotype: Specimen derived from non-original collection selected as the type, when original specimen is missing or destroyed.

Paratype: Specimen cited in the protologue is other than holotype, isotype or syntype.

Epitype: Specimen or illustration serves as an interpretive type, when holotype, neotype or lectotype is ambiguous.

5.6 Taxonomic Aids

Taxonomic aids are the tools for the taxonomic study. Some techniques, procedures and stored information that are useful in identification and classification of organisms are called **taxonomical aids.** They are required in almost all branches of biological studies for their proper identification and for finding their relationship with others. Some of the taxonomical aids are keys, flora, revisions, monograph, catalogues, herbarium, botanical gardens etc.

1. Keys

Taxonomic keys are the tools for the identification of unfamiliar plants. These keys are based on characters which are stable and reliable. The most common type of key is a dichotomous key. It consists of a sequence of two contrasting statements. A pair of contrasting statements is known as **couplet.** Each statement is known as **lead.** The plant is correctly identified with keys by narrowing down the characters found in plant.

Example:

1. a) Flowers cream-coloured; fruiting calyx enclosing the berry .....*Physalis*
b) Flowers white or violet; fruiting calyx not enclosing the berry *2*
2. a) Corolla rotate; fruit a berry .....*Solanum*
b) Corolla funnel-form or salver-form; fruit a capsule: *3*
3. a) Radical leaves present; flowers in racemes; fruits without prickles ...*Nicotiana*
b) Radical leaves absent; flowers solitary; fruits with prickles .....*Datura*

Another type of key for identification is the **Polyclave** or **Multi-entry key**. It consists of a list of numerous character states. The user selects all states that match the specimen. Polyclave keys are implemented by a computer algorithm.

2. Flora

Flora is the document of all plant species in a given geographic area. Flora consists of total number of plant species in an area and gives information about flowering season, fruiting season and distribution for the given geographic area. It also provides details on rare and endemic species of that area. Example: Flora of Tamil Nadu Carnatic by K.M.Matthew. Floras are categorized based on the scope and area covered.

Local Flora

It covers the limited areas, usually state, country, city or mountain range. Example: 'Flora of Thiruvannamalai District' by R. Vijaysankar, K. Ravikumar and P. Ravichandran.